
Middle Class Holes 34 - Caitlin Moran

Published by

Gareth Roberts

Estimated reading time

2 min

Added on

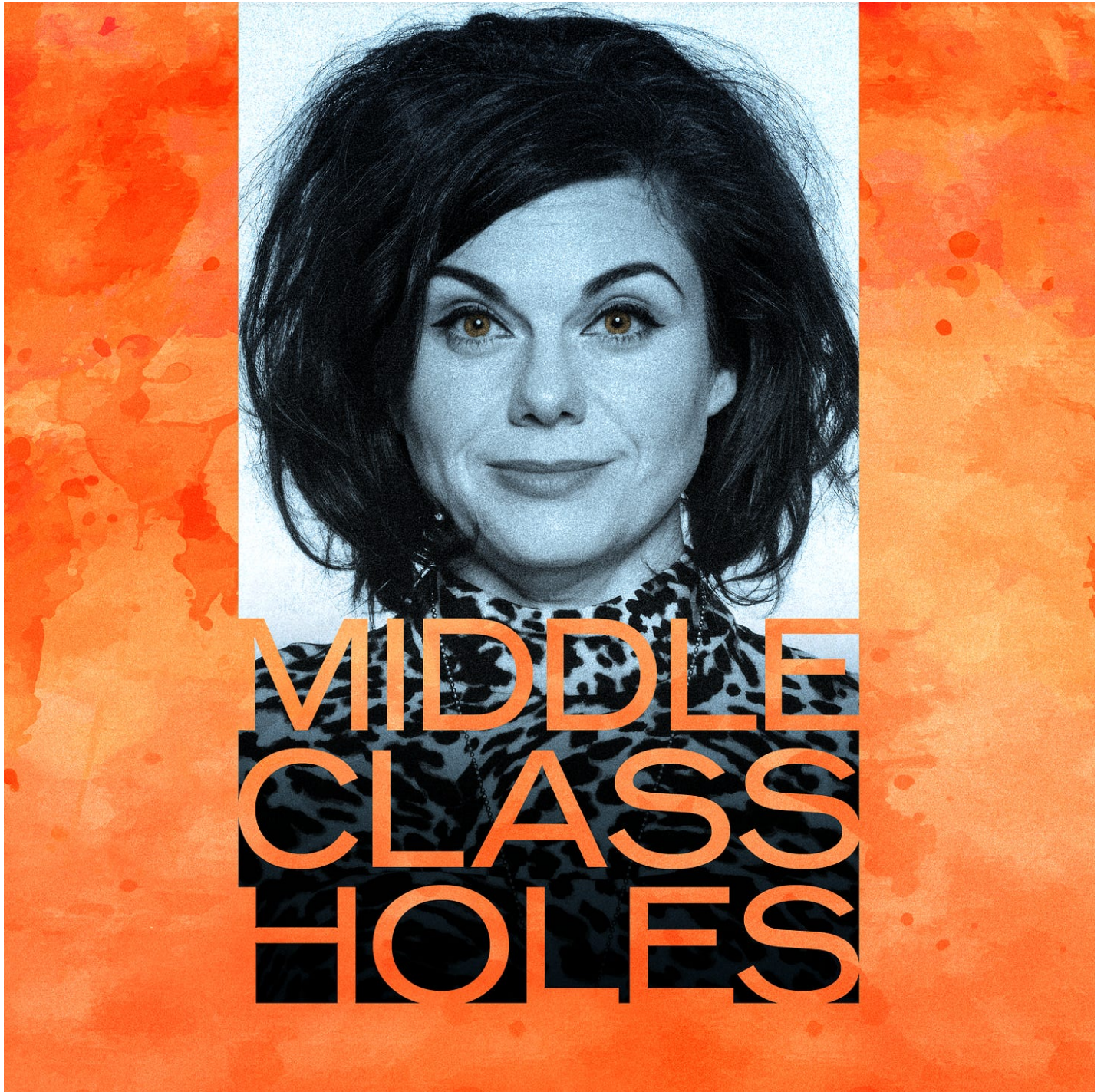
2025-09-26

Address

<https://theageofstupid.substack.com/p/middle-class-holes-34-caitlin-moran?r=44xwv&triedRedirect=true>

Middle Class Holes 34 - Caitlin Moran

I'm mad, me!



Now, one of my rules when I compiled the list of Middle Class Holes was that it couldn't include people I know. And I did, many years ago, enjoy a night out in a smallish group that included today's subject. I found her somewhat overwhelming and voluble, as I expected, primed by my memories of her spell as host of Channel 4's 90s indie pop *Naked City* (not half as exciting as it sounds).

I've been accused of being 'a bit much' myself in my time, and not unreasonably. But when I hit my late thirties the urge to fill awkward gaps in conversation with something/anything just seemed to dry up, replaced by silent staring out of the window and sighing.

Still, I cannot in good conscience throw any stones about today's subject on this specific front. Like many live wire 'creatives', *Times* columnist and prolific writer of cheerful pop-feminist piffle Caitlin Moran is a person best experienced at some distance, delivering occasional little *communiqués*, rather than up close. It's like fizzy pop. A couple of gulps are delightful, and the youthful can knock it back by the gallon, but after a certain age it brings only wind and heartburn. Anyway, I don't think one night out means that she counts as somebody I *know*.

Many of the Middle Class Holes are lacking in talent, but this is not true of Moran. It always feels a little unsporting to pop at someone with wits, but talent doesn't absolve you. And preparing this entry has made me wonder again about this. I thought she was very good, but now I'm not so sure. I've read quite a bit of her output in one go and I found it quite wearing. It is certainly lively, in the way an early teen is lively. It's a cliché that famous people are petrified at the age they became famous, but it's true. Caitlin's precocious gifts were recognised early, and now she is fifty going on fifteen. Some early developers improve hourly; I don't feel this particular bud has flowered very much further since its early discovery.

Then there are the photos. One of the things that always put me off considering a comedy career was the thought of having to pull quirky faces in promo publicity. As in so many areas you're forced into being either an inanely grinning goon or a crusty curmudgeon. (Of course it's even worse being in a band, with its three pictorial options - lark like loons, smoulder, or pretend to be a street gang blocking a corner. When you've witnessed The Dooleys attempt the latter, you've seen everything.) Still, if you're going to have your picture taken a lot, you might as well go for it, and Caitlin certainly has.







What about Moran's class status? Her background, much repeated and mythologised, with its own TV series even, suggests that she was a grubby little oik raised outside the system. In fact, she was reared by semi-posh hippy parents who dropped out to live on a council estate and raise their eight children, of whom Caitlin is the eldest, at the public expense. It's a kind of reverse shabby genteel - genteel shabby.

Moran can be quite defensive about this, for example telling *Attitude* magazine;

Produced by wallabag with tcpdf

Please open [an issue](#) if you have trouble with the display of this E-Book on your device.